Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Tuesday, 27 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light rain	Heavy drizzle	Light drizzle	Light rain
16° 10°	16° 8°	16° 9°	16° 7°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The Chancellor is reportedly planning to protect low-income pensioners from income tax in the upcoming Budget.**

Treasury sources suggest changes are being considered to prevent the full, flat-rate state pension from becoming liable for income tax after its expected rise next April. This move aims to shield those on the lowest incomes.

POLITICS · UK

2 **While Storm Boelo has cleared, more unsettled weather is heading for the UK today.**

Another area of low pressure is forecast to pass close to the north-west of the UK, bringing with it more wind and rain. The Met Office has already issued a yellow wind warning for Tuesday.

WEATHER · UK

3 **An inquest has heard that an Army officer was tragically killed by a reversing Warrior vehicle with a faulty alarm.**

Second Lieutenant Max George, who was 26, died during a training exercise on Salisbury Plain. The inquest is examining the circumstances surrounding the fatal incident.

TRAGEDY · UK

4 **Thousands of homes in the North of England are still without power following the impact of Storm Boelo.**

More than 4,000 properties across Cumbria and the north-east are affected. Engineers are working to restore supplies, but some areas have faced outages for an extended period.

WEATHER · UK

5 **Funding for a plan to get rough sleepers off the streets by Christmas is set to double, according to reports.**

The initiative aims to tackle homelessness and was a key pledge from Andy Burnham upon entering Downing Street in July. The increased funding reflects a commitment to supporting vulnerable individuals.

SOCIAL POLICY · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **A familiar face is returning to the cobbles as a Coronation Street star makes an unexpected comeback after more than a decade.**

The Welsh actor is set to reprise his role as Owen Armstrong, 11 years after last appearing in Weatherfield. He's reportedly looking forward to a 'cracking' new storyline.

ON AIR — What classic Corrie characters would you love to see make a comeback?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Excitement is building for the release of a new book in the popular 'A Court of Thorns and Roses' fantasy series.**

Dozens of fans are planning to gather at Wolverhampton Arts Centre to celebrate the newest instalment. The series has garnered a massive following worldwide.

ON AIR — Are you a fan of fantasy novels? What's your favourite series?

BOOKS · COMING UP

3 **Singer Sam Fender has reportedly called out high ticket prices ahead of his upcoming tour dates.**

The Geordie artist appears to have taken steps to lower ticket costs for his fans. This comes as many concert-goers are facing increased expenses for live music.

ON AIR — Have you ever been put off a gig by the ticket price? What's the most you'd pay?

MUSIC · COMING UP

4 **Grammy-nominated artist MNEK has unfortunately had to cancel his upcoming tour due to low ticket sales and high production costs.**

The singer-songwriter was due to begin a series of shows next month to promote his latest album, 'Bulldozer!!'. It's a real shame for fans who were looking forward to seeing him live.

ON AIR — It's tough for artists these days – how do you think they can best connect with fans for live shows?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 **There's a debate brewing about whether social media is spoiling big gig surprises for music fans.**

Major moments from headline acts are often shared online almost instantly, long before many people get to see their favourite artists perform. It raises questions about how much to reveal.

ON AIR — Do you scroll through social media for gig spoilers, or do you try to avoid them to keep the magic alive?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Eddie Howe and Julian Nagelsmann are reportedly high on Manchester United's list of potential replacements if Michael Carrick is sacked.**

Speculation is mounting around Carrick's future at Old Trafford following recent results. BBC Sport is looking at who could step into the manager's role if a change is made.

ON AIR — If you were in charge at Manchester United, who would be your top choice to take over?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **All eyes will be on the Women's Ballon d'Or ceremony today, with questions over whether anyone can end Spain's domination.**

Spanish players have claimed the prestigious award for the past five years running. Will they be celebrating again tonight, or will a new nation take the top prize?

ON AIR — Who do you think deserves to win the Women's Ballon d'Or this year?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

3 **Ireland prop Tadhg Furlong has been cited over an alleged groin grab during Leinster's United Rugby Championship win against Munster.**

The incident occurred during Saturday's match and will now be reviewed by officials. It's a serious accusation in the world of rugby.

ON AIR — How do you think these kinds of incidents should be dealt with in professional rugby?

RUGBY · UK

4 **Mercedes boss Toto Wolff has hailed Kimi Antonelli's Austin win as 'the best he has delivered', despite not securing the title.**

The young driver's phenomenal performance in the US Grand Prix has drawn high praise. Wolff described it as 'the race of a champion who isn't the champion yet'.

ON AIR — Is Kimi Antonelli the next big thing in Formula 1? What do you make of his potential?

F1 · THIS WEEK

5 **Surrey's head coach Gareth Batty is stepping down from his role to join the Indian Premier League side Chennai Super Kings.**

Batty will take up an assistant head coach position with the renowned IPL team. It marks a significant move for the former England spinner.

ON AIR — Is it a good move for Gareth Batty, or will Surrey miss him? What do you think?

CRICKET · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A new appreciation is growing for the satisfying quiet of a freshly made bed.**
Many are reporting that the simple act of smoothing sheets and plumping pillows brings a surprising sense of calm and order to their morning routine, setting a positive tone for the day.

2 **The comforting tradition of 'Sunday roasts with all the trimmings' is seeing a modern revival across the country.**
More households are dedicating their weekend to slow-cooked meals, finding joy not just in the delicious food, but in the shared experience of preparing and enjoying it together.

3 **Experts suggest that the subtle scent of 'rain on dry earth' can have a profoundly calming effect on our minds.**
This unique aroma, known as petrichor, is being recognised for its ability to reduce stress and evoke feelings of nostalgia and peace.

4 **People are finding unexpected pleasure in the visual appeal of 'a well-organised spice rack'.**
The neat rows of jars and colourful contents are becoming a small, everyday source of satisfaction, turning a functional item into a miniature work of art in the kitchen.

5 **The quiet artistry of 'a perfectly toasted crumpet' is gaining recognition among breakfast enthusiasts.**
Achieving that ideal balance of crisp exterior and fluffy interior, ready to absorb butter, is being celebrated as a small but significant culinary achievement.

6 **The simple act of 'waving goodbye to a departing train' is bringing a momentary sense of connection and nostalgia.**
Even if no one is known on board, the gesture is a quiet acknowledgement of journeys and departures, offering a brief, reflective moment at the station.

7 **There's a growing trend for 'creative repurposing' of old household items, turning clutter into quirky decor.**
From old teacups becoming mini plant pots to vintage suitcases transformed into side tables, people are embracing sustainable and imaginative ways to refresh their living spaces.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING THE BOX A LITTLE SHAKE TO 'FEEL' THE TEXTURE OF THE FLAKES INSIDE!

Q **Our survey said that over 75% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new book, especially if it's a hardback. What is it?**

ANSWER: SMELLING THE PAGES! IT'S ALL ABOUT THAT 'NEW BOOK SMELL'.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have that 'one particular kitchen gadget' that we absolutely adore, even if we only use it once a year. It might be a retro ice cream maker, a fancy garlic press, or even a classic biscuit tin.**
  What's the one kitchen gadget you couldn't bear to part with, no matter how often (or rarely) you use it? And why is it so special to you?

- **You know how sometimes a specific 'everyday street name' or 'place name' just always makes you smile, perhaps because it's a bit quirky, or sounds funny, or just brings back a happy memory?**
  What's a local street name or place name that always brings a grin to your face, and what's the story behind why you love it so much?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of hedgehogs is called a 'prickle'?

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The unique black and white stripes of a zebra are like fingerprints – no two zebras have exactly the same pattern.
- The Great Barrier Reef, off the coast of Australia, is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from space.
- Wombats are the only animals in the world whose faeces are cube-shaped.
- The national animal of Scotland is the unicorn.
- A cloud, on average, weighs about 550 tons, which is roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named Methuselah, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- The game of 'Draughts' (or checkers) is one of the oldest board games, with a board found in Ur dating back to 3000 BC.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES TUE 27 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 300 of the year, 65 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abbán; Christian feast day: Abraham the Poor; Christian feast day: Gaudiosus of Naples; Christian feast day: Kaleb of Axum. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1938 — Lara Parker, American actress and author (died 2023)
- 1993 — Troy Gentile, American actor
- 1939 — Dallas Frazier, American country music singer-songwriter (died 2022)
- 1951 — Jayne Kennedy, American model, actress, and sportscaster
- 1942 — Lee Greenwood, American singer-songwriter
- 1992 — Emily Hagins, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1958 — David Hazeltine, American pianist and composer
- 1958 — Simon Le Bon, English singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1954 — Benjamin O. Davis, Jr. becomes the first African-American general in the United States Air Force.
- 1994 — Gliese 229B is the first Substellar Mass Object to be unquestionably identified.
- 1993 — Widerøe Flight 744 crashes in Overhalla Municipality, Norway, killing six people.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1992 — United States Navy radioman Allen R. Schindler, Jr. is murdered by shipmate Terry M. Helvey for being gay, precipitating debate about gays in the military that results in the United States' "Don't ask, don't tell" military policy.
- 1979 — Saint Vincent and the Grenadines gains its independence from the United Kingdom.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1930 — Ratifications are exchanged in London for the first London Naval Treaty go into effect immediately, further limiting the expensive naval arms race among its five signatories.
- 1964 — Ronald Reagan delivers a speech on behalf of the Republican candidate for president, Barry Goldwater. The speech launches his political career and comes to be known as "A Time for Choosing".

- 2014 — Britain withdraws from Afghanistan at the end of Operation Herrick, after 12 years four months and seven days.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES WED 28 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 301 of the year, 64 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abdias of Babylon; Christian feast day: Abgar V of Edessa (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Eadsige; Christian feast day: Faro. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1967 — Kevin Macdonald, Scottish director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1938 — Anne Perry, English author (died 2023)
- 1983 — Joe Thomas, English actor and screenwriter
- 1978 — Gwendoline Christie, English actress
- 1978 — Justin Guarini, American singer-songwriter and actor
- 1987 — Frank Ocean, American singer-songwriter
- 1966 — Chris Bauer, American actor
- 2001 — Sonay Kartal, British tennis player

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2009 — US President Barack Obama signs the Matthew Shepard and James Byrd Jr. Hate Crimes Prevention Act.
- 1995 — The Baku Metro fire sees 289 people killed and 270 injured.
- 1989 — Aloha Island Air Flight 1712, a Twin Otter 300, crashed into terrain at night in Hawaii killing all 20 occupants onboard.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2018 — Jair Bolsonaro is elected president of Brazil with 57 million votes, with Workers' Party candidate Fernando Haddad as the runner-up. It is the first time in 16 years that a Workers' Party candidate is not elected president.
- 1956 — Hungarian Revolution: A de facto ceasefire comes into effect between armed revolutionaries and Soviet troops, who begin to withdraw from Budapest. Communist officials and facilities come under attack by revolutionaries.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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